

CLINICAL OUTCOMES IN ROUTINE EVALUATION

Outcome Measure (CORE-OM)

Therapist name:

Patient name:

Date:

Trust ID number:

Important – please read first.

This form has 34 statements about how you have been OVER THE LAST WEEK.

Please read each statement and think how often you felt that way last week.

Then tick the box which is closest to it.

	Not at all	Only Occasionally	Sometimes	Often	Most or all of the time	Office use only
Over the last week:						
1. I have felt terribly alone and isolated	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
2. I have felt tense, anxious or nervous	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
3. I have felt I have someone to turn to for support when needed	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
4. I have felt OK about myself	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ W
5. I have felt totally lacking energy and enthusiasm	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
6. I have been physically violent to others	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R
7. I have felt able to cope when things go wrong	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
8. I have been troubled by aches, pains or other physical problems	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
9. I have thought of hurting myself	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R
10. Talking to people has felt too much for me	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
11. Tension and anxiety have prevented me doing important things	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
12. I have been happy with the things I have done	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
13. I have been disturbed by unwanted thoughts and feelings	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
14. I have felt like crying	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ W
15. I have felt panic or terror	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
16. I have made plans to end my life	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R
17. I have felt overwhelmed by my problems	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ W
18. I have had difficulty getting to sleep or staying asleep	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P

Over the last week:	Not at all	Only Occasionally	Sometimes	Often	Most or all of the time	Office use only
19. I have felt warmth or affection for someone	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
20. My problems have been impossible to put to one side	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
21. I have been able to do most things I needed to	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
22. I have threatened or intimidated another person	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R
23. I have felt despairing or hopeless	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
24. I have thought it would be better if I were dead	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R
25. I have felt criticised by other people	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
26. I have thought I have no friends	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
27. I have felt unhappy	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
28. Unwanted images or memories have been distressing me	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
29. I have been irritable when with other people	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
30. I have thought I am to blame for my problems and difficulties	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ P
31. I have felt optimistic about my future	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ W
32. I have achieved the things I wanted to	☐ 4	☐ 3	☐ 2	☐ 1	☐ 0	☐ F
33. I have felt humiliated or shamed by other people	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ F
34. I have hurt myself physically or taken dangerous risks with my health	☐ 0	☐ 1	☐ 2	☐ 3	☐ 4	☐ R

THANK YOU FOR YOUR TIME IN COMPLETING THIS QUESTIONNAIRE

TOTAL SCORES

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐ → ☐
↓	↓	↓	↓	↓

MEAN SCORES

(Total score for each dimension divided by
number of items completed in that dimension)

☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
(W)	(P)	(F)	(R)	All items	All minus R

CLINICAL OUTCOMES IN ROUTINE EVALUATION-OUTCOME MEASURE (CORE-OM)

Background Information

The CORE-OM (Evans et al, 2000) is a generic self-report measure of global distress, including subjective well-being, commonly experienced problems or symptoms, social/life functioning and risk to self and others. The measure is suitable for use as an initial screening tool and for assessing response to psychological therapy across a wide range of service types. The CORE-OM is sensitive to change and has high internal and test-retest reliability (Evans et al 2000).

Description of the CORE-OM

The CORE-OM is comprising 34 items designed to measure global distress. **Eight of the items (3, 4, 7, 12, 19, 21, 31, 32) are positively framed** e.g. 'I have felt optimistic about my future'. The 34 items can be separated into the following four subscales, each subscale being a dimension of global distress: Subjective Well Being (4 items), Problems/Symptoms (12 items), Functioning (including general functioning, functioning in close relationships and functioning in social relationships; 12 items) and Risk (including harm to self and harm to others; 6 items). The dimension to which an item belongs is indicated on the measure by W (Subjective Well Being), P (Problems/Symptoms), F (Functioning) or R (Risk).

Scoring the CORE-OM

Each of the 34 items is scored on a 5-point scale ranging from 0-4 (0 = not at all, 4 = most of the time). **Scores are reversed for the positively framed items.** Total and mean scores can be calculated for all items (global distress) and for each of the four dimensions, as follows:

Global Distress: Adding all item scores gives a score of global distress ranging from 0-136.

A mean of the total score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 or 2 items are not complete, mean scores can be calculated by dividing the total score by the number of complete items.

Well-Being Dimension Score: Adding the 4 'W' item scores gives a total Well-Being score ranging from 0-16. A mean of the Well-Being score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 item is incomplete, a mean score can still be calculated.

NB The measure is problem scored: the higher the score, the more problems/distress the individual is reporting. Although this may seem counter-intuitive with regards to 'Well-Being', scoring is kept this way for consistency with the other dimensions.

Problems/Symptoms Dimension Score: Adding the 12 'P' item scores gives a total Problems/Symptoms score ranging from 0-48. A mean of the Problems/Symptoms score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 item is incomplete, a mean score can still be calculated.

Functioning: Adding the 12 'F' item scores gives a total Functioning score ranging from 0-48. A mean of the Functioning score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 item is incomplete, a mean score can still be calculated.

Risk: Adding the 6 'R' item scores gives a total Risk score ranging from 0-24. A mean of the Risk score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 item is incomplete, a mean score can still be calculated.

NB 'Risk' items are intended to be used as clinical indicators of risk rather than as a scale.

As such, a Global Distress Score and mean can be calculated without the risk items as follows:

Global Distress score minus Risk: Adding all 28 'W', 'P' and 'F' item scores gives a score of global distress minus risk ranging from 0-112. A mean of this score can then be calculated and will range from 0-4. If only 1 or 2 items are not complete, mean scores can be calculated by dividing the total score by the number of complete 'W', 'P' and 'F' items.

Interpretation of Scores

Normative data: The Core System User Manual gives mean scores (ranging from 0-4) for clinical and non clinical populations. These are shown in the table below:

Dimension	Mean Score (SD) clinical population ¹	Mean Score (SD) non-clinical population ²
Subjective Well Being (W)	2.37 (0.96)	0.91 (0.83)
Problems or Symptoms (P)	2.31 (0.88)	0.90 (0.72)
Functioning (F)	1.86 (0.84)	0.85 (0.65)
Risk (R)	0.63 (0.75)	0.20 (0.45)
Total minus Risk	2.12 (0.81)	0.88 (0.66)
Global Distress (Total)	1.86 (0.75)	0.76 (0.59)

¹ Clinical population n=890 from 19 NHS sites, 1 university counselling service and 1 staff support service

² Non-clinical population n=1106

For all dimensions, the mean scores for clinical and non-clinical populations significantly differ ($p < 0.0005$)

Cut off scores: Clinical cut off mean scores for Males and Females are given as follows:

Dimension	Males	Females
Subjective Well Being (W)	1.37	1.77
Problems or Symptoms (P)	1.44	1.62
Functioning (F)	1.29	1.30
Risk (R)	0.43	0.31
Total minus Risk	1.36	1.50
Global Distress (Total)	1.19	1.29

CORE-OM for elderly

Normative data are available for elderly people (Barkham, Culverwell, Spindler, Twigg & Connell, in press). The sample consisted of 118 elderly people (aged 65-97) presenting for mental health treatment and 214 people from a non-clinical sample (aged 65-94). Results showed that the CORE-OM is a reliable measure in both clinical and non-clinical samples for the overall mean items. Large overall differences were observed between the clinical and non-clinical elderly sample, indicating that it is equally sensitive in the older age band as it is for the working age adults. However, the norms for the elderly clinical sample were lower than the equivalent clinical norms for a working age sample. Hence, the norms for elderly CORE-OM should be used for the older population.

	Clinical population		Non-clinical population	
Dimension	Male (N=37)	Female (N=61)	Male (N=47)	Female (N=137)
Mean global distress score (SD) of CORE-OM for elderly	1.50 (0.60)	1.55 (0.57)	0.54 (0.44)	0.63 (0.33)

The clinical cut-off for the elderly is shown below:

Clinical cut-off for elderly	Male 0.95	Female 0.97
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Correlations with other measures: Barkham et al (2001) report that the full CORE-OM correlates most highly with measures of symptoms, such as the Symptoms Checklist-90-Revised (SCL-90-R) and the Brief Symptom Inventory (BSI), and measures of depression such as the Beck Depression Inventory I and II (BDI and BDI-II). For all these measures Spearman's Rho > 0.80.

The CORE-OM also correlates highly with the Beck Anxiety Inventory (BAI, Spearman's Rho = 0.65) and the Inventory of Interpersonal Problems-32 item version (IIP-32, Spearman's Rho = 0.65).

Key References

Barkham M., Culverwell A., Spindler K., Twigg E., & Connell J. (in press). The CORE-OM in an older population: Psychometric status, acceptability and feasibility. *Ageing & Mental Health*.

Barkham, M., Margison, F., Leach, C., Lucock, M., Mellor-Clark, J., Evans, C., Benson, L., Connell, J., Audin, K. and McGrath, G (2001). Service Profiling and Outcomes Benchmarking: Toward Practice-Based Evidence in the Psychological Therapies. *Journal of Consulting and Clinical Psychology* Vol 69, No. 2, 184-196.

Core System User Manual. Available at <http://www.coreims.co.uk>

Evans, C., Connell, Barkham, Margiso, F., Mellor-Clark, J., McGrath, G., G. & Audin, K., (2002). Towards a standardised brief outcome measure. Psychometric properties & utility of the CORE-OM. *British Journal of Psychiatry* 180, 54-60.

Evans, C., Mellor-Clark, J., Margison, F., Barkham, M., Audin, K., Connell, J. and McGrath, G (2000). CORE: Clinical Outcomes in Routine Evaluation. *Journal of Mental Health*, 9, 3, 247-255.